When the engineer who knows leaves

Northstar Digital - operations handover pack

The situation

Northstar Digital runs a customer-facing application supported by a small engineering team. Alex Morgan, the Senior DevOps Engineer, is leaving in approximately one week. Several operational routines still depend on Alex's experience and personal walkthroughs.

Daniel Reed needs to understand which responsibilities are documented, where the instructions leave questions, and what the remaining engineers need to learn before Alex departs. This pack contains the current notes; it is not evidence that a handover or recovery test has been completed.

People and current responsibilities

Person	Current responsibility or involvement
Alex Morgan	Senior DevOps Engineer. Owns PostgreSQL database backups and restoration, Production API releases, VPS infrastructure, and Monitoring and alerting configuration.
Maya Chen	Backend Engineer. Has read the database runbook and attended a walkthrough with Alex. Has not independently restored a backup.
Daniel Reed	Engineering Lead. Approves release windows and recovery test scope. Coordinates the departure handover.
Priya Shah	Platform Engineer. Handles access requests. Is interested in learning the Deployment pipeline, but no transfer of release ownership has been approved.
Jordan Lee	Frontend Engineer. Checks the customer interface after application releases. No database recovery responsibility is recorded.

Backup and restoration

Maintainer: Alex Morgan | Applies to: PostgreSQL database and Backup storage

Routine backup

Alex Morgan owns the PostgreSQL database backup schedule and restore procedure. A nightly database dump is sent to Backup storage. Alex normally checks the backup completion notification each morning. The on-call engineer should investigate when that notification does not arrive.

The precise backup schedule and retention settings are maintained outside these notes. Alex can identify the current completed backup during a walkthrough.

Restoration procedure

1. Obtain Daniel Reed's approval and confirm that the target is an isolated recovery database. This document does not authorize changes to production.

2. Retrieve the latest completed nightly dump from Backup storage.

3. Validate the dump checksum using the usual method before loading the isolated recovery database.

4. Restore the selected dump into the isolated recovery database using the team's standard restoration tooling.

5. Check the expected application records and ask Maya Chen to review the result.

6. Record the test observations, supporting evidence, and any blocked or unclear steps in the handover record.

Current handover note

Maya Chen has read this procedure and attended a walkthrough, but has not independently completed it. No restoration test report, elapsed recovery time, or independently observed result is attached to this pack.

Backup storage is listed in the systems inventory. These notes do not contain credentials or grant access to that storage. Priya Shah is the contact for access requests.

Release and on-call notes

Maintainer: Alex Morgan | Applies to: Production API, Deployment pipeline, VPS infrastructure, Monitoring and alerting

Production release procedure

1. Obtain Daniel Reed's approval for the release window.

2. Alex Morgan starts the release through the Deployment pipeline after the automated checks complete.

3. Jordan Lee checks the customer interface and Maya Chen checks the Production API response after the release.

4. If the release appears unhealthy, use the previous stable release and check Monitoring and alerting before closing the change.

Monitoring and incident response

Alex Morgan maintains the service dashboards and alert routing. Alex normally receives the infrastructure alerts and knows which thresholds need attention during a release. The team should contact Alex if a dashboard or alert does not look right.

The current recipient list and dashboard links are not copied into this pack. Jordan's interface check does not include validating infrastructure alerts or the backup completion notification.

Coverage discussion

Priya Shah has offered to learn the Deployment pipeline. Daniel Reed has not yet approved that assignment. No acceptance of Alex's VPS infrastructure or Monitoring and alerting responsibilities is recorded here.

Maya Chen can explain the backend data model. That knowledge has not yet been demonstrated through an independent restoration test. Alex's walkthrough and the existence of this pack should not be treated as proof that another engineer can recover the service.

Handover status

These are the notes available for review. Follow-up owners, deadlines, approval decisions, and test results will be recorded separately after the team reviews the documented responsibilities and instructions.